

Hello!

I'm Jake Dawkins

Open Source Engineer

Apollo GraphQL

@jakedawkins



Things to ask me about

- Working at a startup
- Working remote
- My work (GraphQL/dev tools)
- Open Source
- Networking/Social Media
- Conference/Meetup Speaking

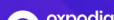
About my Work

(trying not to break the internet)

[Platform](#)[Pricing](#)[Developers](#)[Enterprise](#)[Company](#)[Launch Studio](#)

The Apollo Data Graph Platform

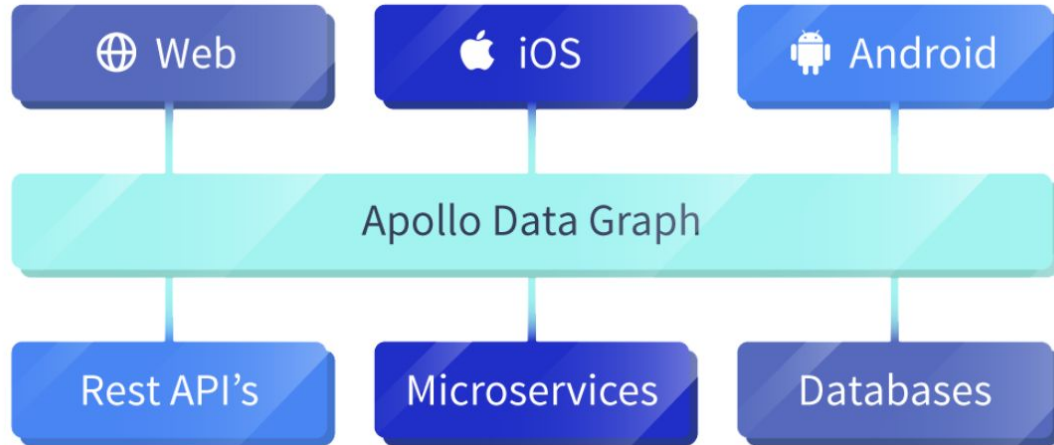
Simplify app development by combining APIs, databases, and microservices into a single data graph that you can query with GraphQL

[Start the Tutorial](#)[Talk to an Expert](#)

The NerdWallet logo, featuring a stylized "N" icon.



apollographql.com



```

query Query($productsFirst: Int) { ...
  products(first: $productsFirst) {
    edges {
      product {
        upc
        name
        price
      }
    }
  }
}

```

```

{
  "data": {
    "products": {
      "edges": [
        {
          "product": {
            "upc": "1",
            "name": "Table",
            "price": 899
          }
        },
        {
          "product": {
            "upc": "2",
            "name": "Couch",
            "price": 1299
          }
        }
      ]
    }
  }
}

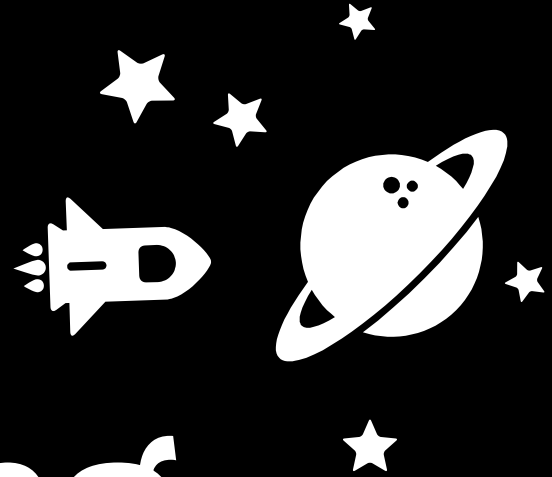
```



<http://npmjs.com/apollo>

Remote Networking

(Making friends on the internet)



**Networking
isn't just about
getting a job**

Networking isn't just about getting a job

What is the goal of networking?

To know people for
when you need to know people

Where to network

- twitter
- blogs
- meetups
- conferences

Strategies

- Learn in public
- teach as an expert
- show interesting use cases
- talk about crazy new ideas

Twitter

1.

- Many major contributors to libraries and even the languages themselves spend time on twitter
- Pose questions and answers to others' questions
- Learn in public! Thread together short thoughts about a specific idea
- Post regularly. Create a series!



Jake Dawkins @JakeDawkins · Oct 2, 2018

🔥👉 Tuesday's tip-top tip 👉🔥

You can set default values for field arguments right inside your schema, including lists and enum values!

Check it out (or fork it): codesandbox.io/s/1yr266p9kl

```
enum AllowedColor {  
  RED  
  GREEN  
}  
  
type Query {  
  avatar(  
    aString: String = "test"  
    anArrayOfEnum: [AllowedColor!] = [RED]  
  ): String  
}
```



1



11



43



Tip

Blogs

2.

- You don't have to be an expert to write.
- Think about topics like error handling, debugging, and cool language features
- if something was confusing to you, it was probably confusing to someone else
- Blogs can solicit conversation and questions (places like medium or dev.to)
- They also act as a *great* reference for your skills/work for your resume.

Meetups ([meetup.com](https://www.meetup.com))

3.

- Like micro-conferences.
- Attend or speak!
- Often caters to newer people. They allow more talks at a lower technical level.
- Nowadays, these are almost exclusively online
- Many meetups are more desperate for content than ever
- Talks can be pre-recorded or live
- Sometimes, these are even paid gigs :)

Conferences

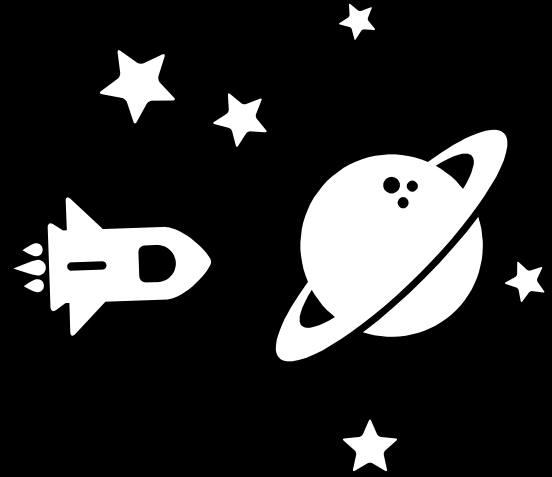
4.

- Attending or speaking at conferences are great ways to meet people!
- Easier to get approved for if you've already spoken at meetups multiple times.
- Higher technical bar of excellence, and requires a lot more preparation.
- Fantastic place to meet people and get your name known as an "expert" in a topic, even if it's a really narrow topic.

My Experiences

Convincing companies to do things

(Making your job and career more exciting)

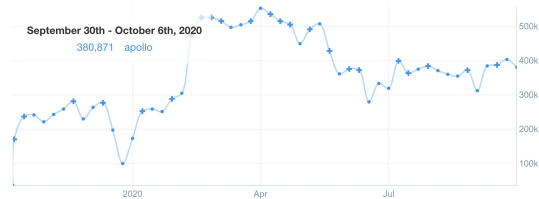


1.

**Have a
real problem**

My Problem

- Distribution
- Performance
- Code smell & technical debt
- I was the only active maintainer of the project





<http://npmjs.com/apollo>

2.

**Figure out what
you actually want**

What we wanted

(what makes a good CLI)

- Accessible for all, no matter tech stack
- Gets out of the way
 - Including time spent installing AND running
- Understandable
 - To both humans AND machines (CI)
 - understandable errors

3.

**Find a
candidate solution**

Rust



- Rust's rise at Mozilla & other companies
- Dev experience & performance.
- Interest within Apollo
- After looking into cargo & the Rust build tooling

4.

**Proof
of Concept**

Building a good PoC

- Rust was never a given
- I made a move when the most people were together
- I wanted to prove **OUR** CLI could be built well
- PoC with relevance to our work

5.

**Make your
case to the
people who matter**



Stakeholders



Presenting the PoC

- Challenge
- Code snippets of what I had to do to get it all working
- Very basic benchmarks of bootup time and distribution size comparisons between a base Rust & TypeScript CLI

Pushback

- The feedback was very positive, but naturally skeptical.
- We already had a systems language widely used in the company—Kotlin
- Others in the company speaking up

**Where
we're at today**

Thanks!



Any questions?

You can find me at

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- jake@apollographql.com